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SECTION 02

Industry Talk Reflection

LECTURER: DR. NOORFA HASZLINNA BINTI MUSTAFFA

GROUP DECISION MAKERS

Student Name	Matric No.
JOANNE CHING YIN XUAN	A23CS0227
GOE JIE YING	A23CS0224
EVELYN GOH YUAN QI	A23CS0222
LING YU QIAN	A23CS0301

1.0 INTRODUCTION

The industry sharing session, “Bridging Data & Decisions: The Role of Data Governance and Data Management in Modern Business Intelligence,” was presented by Faiz Fablillah at the UTM Faculty of Computing on 20 May 2026. The speaker is a Senior Principal in Enterprise Data & AI Governance at PIDM and a Certified Data Management Professional (CDMP) with more than 15 years of cross-industry experience in financial services, manufacturing, and oil & gas sectors. In addition, his involvement with DAMA Kuala Lumpur & Selangor and academic background in Business Analytics from Imperial College London further reflected his expertise in the field of data governance and analytics.

The purpose of the talk was to highlight the importance of data governance to support AI, data management and Business Intelligence (BI). The speaker emphasized that most organizations often focus on dashboards. However, data governance and management should not be overlooked because the dashboards and business insights can only be trusted when the data used is secure and complies with requirements. Therefore, governance is important in BI as it ensures the reliability of data before it reaches the dashboard and decision making stages.

2.0 KEY TAKEAWAYS

The Role And Responsibilities Of Data Governance

The talk explained that data governance plays an important role in ensuring that organizational data is accurate, secure, and trustworthy. According to the speaker, data governance involves creating policies, standards, and guidelines on how data should be collected, stored, accessed, and used within an organization. The speaker emphasized that dashboards and analytical reports are only useful when the underlying data is reliable, as poor-quality data can lead to misleading insights and poor business decisions.

In addition, the session highlighted accountability and compliance as important responsibilities of data governance. Organizations should be able to identify where their data comes from and understand how it is processed across different systems. The speaker also explained that governance helps organizations comply with data privacy and security regulations. Overall, the talk demonstrated that data governance is becoming increasingly important as organizations rely more heavily on analytics, AI, and data-driven decision-making.

How Data Governance Bridges the Gap Between Raw Data and Business Decisions

Data governance ensures the data is secure, trusted and properly managed before transforming raw data into meaningful business decisions. It bridges the gap by applying policies, ownership, and data quality checks to validate and control data before it is used in dashboards or analytics. This can help to strengthen trust between data users and data owners, allowing businesses to make informed decisions based on reliable and well-governed data.

Tools, technologies and practices

Several tools, technologies, and practices were mentioned during the talk, including Master Data Management (MDM), automated data quality checks, data lineage tracking, centralized data

catalogs, and intelligent access controls. These technologies help organizations improve data accuracy, security, and trust within Business Intelligence (BI) systems. The speaker also emphasized the importance of metadata management, data monitoring, and AI-assisted governance to support reliable and ethical business decision-making.

Real-world use cases or examples shared by the speaker

The speaker also shared real-world examples of data quality failures, such as banks sending loan offers to deceased customers due to outdated records, hospitals showing incorrect COVID-19 data because of broken data feeds, and companies reporting conflicting revenue numbers between departments. Case studies included a Malaysian bank using MDM to create a centralized “Golden Record” for customers, a telco reducing over 200 dashboards to 50 trusted dashboards, and a healthcare organization implementing PII detection and audit trails to achieve PDPA compliance and secure patient data.

3.0 REFLECTION AND CRITICAL INSIGHTS

JOANNE CHING YIN XUAN

From my perspective, the most valuable part of the talk delivered by Faiz Fablillah was the explanation that Business Intelligence is not only about creating dashboards, but also about ensuring that the data used is accurate and trustworthy. The talk connected closely with topics learned in class such as ETL processes, data warehousing, and Business Intelligence pipelines, where data must be properly managed before useful insights can be produced. I was also interested in the discussion on how AI is creating new governance-related roles in the industry. In my opinion, analytics engineering and data governance are becoming increasingly important because organizations now depend heavily on data-driven decisions and AI technologies. The session also inspired me to explore how organizations can ensure that AI systems remain ethical and trustworthy while handling large amounts of data.

LING YU QIAN

Mr. Faiz’s presentation highlighted that technical skills alone are not enough in the data industry; governance, trust, and business impact are what truly set professionals apart. One of the most valuable insights was that graduates who understand data governance tend to progress faster because they can connect technical work to real business decisions. The example of reducing dashboards from 200 to 50 also showed that fewer, more reliable insights can increase user trust and adoption, proving that quality matters more than quantity. The talk linked well with what we learned in class about databases and data extraction while adding real-world concepts like data lineage, metadata management, and governance frameworks such as DAMA-DMBOK. It also emphasized that analytics engineering and governance are critical in today’s business environment, as poor data quality can cause operational failures, regulatory issues, and loss of trust, while AI governance is increasingly important for ensuring fairness, privacy, and compliance. The session further raised important questions about how organizations can balance strong data governance with the fast pace of AI development and how smaller companies can effectively implement data governance practices using practical tools like data catalogs.

GOE JIE YING

Previously, the data engineering studies focus was usually on building data pipelines and data governance was viewed as a minor topic and mainly understood as a method for securing data and privacy. One of the key takeaways from this talk is that data governance and management are more important than initially assumed, especially before creating dashboards and business insights. Without proper governance and management to ensure data quality and trustworthiness, the result may be unreliable and not trusted. However, applying governance rules strictly to all the data used may also reduce efficiency in the current business ecosystem, particularly in large-scale systems. Therefore, it is important to balance between data governance and performance to achieve better outcomes. As a suggestion, AI can potentially be utilized to support both governance and management processes without reducing system efficiency.

EVELYN GOH YUAN QI

The industry talk provided valuable insights into the importance of data governance and data management in modern Business Intelligence (BI). The session highlighted that data analytics is not only about creating dashboards and reports, but also about ensuring data accuracy, security, trust, and ethical usage through proper governance practices such as metadata management, data lineage, and quality monitoring. The discussion on AI-assisted governance was particularly interesting because it demonstrated how AI can automate technical processes while human oversight and ethical judgment remain essential. The talk was highly relevant to concepts learned in the Business Intelligence course, especially in areas related to data quality, analytics processes, and decision-making systems. Overall, the session broadened understanding of the growing importance of governance knowledge and encouraged greater interest in analytics engineering and data governance as future career paths.

4.0 CONCLUSION

Overall, the talk provided valuable insights into the importance of data governance and data management in modern business intelligence. The session helped strengthen understanding of how analytics and governance work together to transform raw data into trusted business decisions. The speaker successfully connected industry practices with real-world challenges, making the topic more relevant and practical for students. The talk also highlighted the growing importance of governance skills in the AI era, where technical knowledge alone is no longer sufficient. Besides, it was informative, engaging, and beneficial in broadening perspectives on future career opportunities in analytics, business intelligence, and data engineering. These real-world examples radically shift the perspective from purely "building algorithms" to focusing on data trust and governance. The talk illustrates that knowing how to write SQL or build Tableau dashboards is now merely a "Basic Expectation." To stand out, my academic focus must broaden to include systems thinking and data quality. It opens up highly relevant, emerging career paths such as data governance analyst, data steward and AI/ML governance specialist—roles where the demand is currently outpacing traditional data science positions.